

**UNITED NATIONS**  **NATIONS UNIES**  
**DEPARTMENT OF ECONOMIC AND SOCIAL AFFAIRS**

**ITALIAN FELLOWSHIPS PROGRAMME  
FOR TECHNICAL COOPERATION  
CAPACITY BUILDING AND HUMAN RESOURCES DEVELOPMENT  
2025-2026**

**Fellowship Award Specification**

**United Nations World Food Programme (WFP)  
Cuba Country Office Part of WFP Latin America and Caribbean Regional Office**

**1. General Information**

|                                       |                            |
|---------------------------------------|----------------------------|
| <u>Title:</u>                         | UN Fellow                  |
| <u>Orientation Workshop dates:</u>    | May 2026 (tbc)             |
| <u>Assignment in the field dates:</u> | May 2026 – May 2027 (tbc)  |
| <u>Duty Station:</u>                  | Havana, Cuba               |
| <u>Sector of assignment:</u>          | Partnerships and Reporting |

**2. Supervision**

|                                 |                      |
|---------------------------------|----------------------|
| <u>Name of the Supervisor:</u>  | Ms. Sheyla Quintana  |
| <u>Title of the Supervisor:</u> | Partnerships Officer |

**3. Background information**

The world is currently experiencing one of the most severe food crises in recent history, exacerbated by the lingering effects of the COVID-19 pandemic and ongoing international conflicts that have deeply impacted the socio-economic stability of many countries. The Latin American region, in particular, is facing compounded challenges including the climate crisis, rising migration flows, inflation-driven debt, and soaring food prices. This deterioration in food security poses a significant concern for the World Food Programme (WFP), given its critical role in supporting governments to safeguard access to food for the most vulnerable populations.

Cuba is currently facing significant challenges in the area of food security and nutrition (FSN). Although FSN has remained a government priority—clearly reflected in the National Plan for Economic and Social Development through 2030—the country is undergoing its most severe socio-economic crisis in the past three decades. This situation poses a serious threat to the food security of the Cuban population, particularly among vulnerable groups.

Beyond structural challenges, Cuba's economic and financial situation has been severely affected by the COVID-19 pandemic, the ongoing embargo, and the consequences of recent monetary reforms—all of which have contributed to a sharp rise in prices. The ripple effects of the conflict between Ukraine and Russia are expected to further aggravate the island's current hardships. Additionally, Venezuela's economic recession continues to impact Cuba's oil supply, leading to disruptions in energy and transportation services and contributing to a broader decline in economic output.

Considering the complex food security and nutrition (FSN) landscape, the World Food Programme (WFP) has supported the Government of Cuba in strengthening the resilience of local food systems through its Country Strategic Plan, spanning from July 2021 to December 2024. Aligned with Sustainable Development Goals 2 (Zero Hunger), 5 (Gender Equality), and 17 (Partnerships for the Goals), the plan is structured around four strategic outcomes:

- **Strategic Outcome 1:** Ensures continued access to food for populations affected by shocks, both during and after emergencies, including the national response to the COVID-19 pandemic.
- **Strategic Outcome 2:** Focuses on improving the nutritional status of vulnerable groups, particularly children, pregnant and lactating women, and the elderly.
- **Strategic Outcome 3:** Enhances the capacity of local food systems to supply nutritious food to social protection programmes, with an emphasis on school feeding and community canteens.
- **Strategic Outcome 4:** Strengthens national and local institutional capacities to support a more integrated and sustainable approach to food security and nutrition.

WFP Cuba operates in a dynamic donor landscape and a complex national context, which demands a strong partnerships and resource mobilization strategy to ensure the uninterrupted implementation of its Country Strategic Plan and to effectively address food and nutrition security challenges. The strategy prioritizes the mobilization of flexible funding and accurate forecasting to sustain all strategic outcomes, including agricultural development, support to social protection systems, and emergency response. To reinforce these critical efforts, WFP Cuba is currently seeking a Volunteer Assistant to support the Partnerships and Resource Mobilization Unit.

#### **4. Duties, responsibilities and output expectations:**

Under the direct supervision of the Partnerships Officer, in liaison and collaboration with other WFP units as appropriate, the Fellow will be responsible for the following duties:

##### **Partnerships:**

- Support the implementation of the partnership and strategic agreement strategy with key stakeholders and potential counterparts to advance WFP's strategic objectives (donors, government entities, international financial institutions, NGOs, academia, and other United Nations agencies).
- Support discussions with the aforementioned key stakeholders regarding specific proposed projects, as well as the preparation of proposals, agreements, or memoranda of understanding to be signed with them; this includes preparing presentations and proposals tailored to each institution and providing support during discussions and negotiation processes that may arise.
- Assist in providing relevant recommendations for managing existing partnerships and collaborate in adjusting the office's strategy in response to changes in the national context, including identifying new opportunities, making forecasts, and offering ongoing support in risk analysis and mitigation strategies.

- With support from the Programme Unit, assist in designing and managing resource mobilization processes, including drafting proposals, documents, or letters addressed to donors and/or counterparts, ensuring alignment with the office's overall strategy.
- Support other technical units across the organization to ensure alignment with donor requirements, proper management of cooperating partners, and provide guidance for the effective administration and mobilization of additional donor resources.
- Assist in preparing monthly, quarterly, semi-annual, or annual reports and summaries as required or requested by donors and/or organizational counterparts.
- Support the organization and coordination of preparations for external events and field missions.
- Support the update of the country office's resource mobilization strategy and contribute to the review and update of the Partnership Action Plan, ensuring both documents are aligned with the Country Strategic Plan.
- Provide assistance to keep donor intelligence information up to date in the corporate tool "Salesforce."
- Support the integration of organizational guidelines related to gender equality and the mainstreaming of protection across all activities and projects.

#### **Reporting area :**

1. Support the preparation of Daily Operation Brief (when needed), Country Briefs (with monthly basis), WFP Situation Reports and Logistic and Food Security sectors analysis to contribute to the UN Common Situation Report (in case of emergencies), and other ad-hoc reports requested by donors and WFP headquarters.
2. Contribute to the development of the Annual Country Report (ACR) which is the main corporate performance report addressed to donors.
3. Support the editing and translation of systematization products elaborated by Programme area focused on key activities and processes, best practices, innovation, and lessons learnt emerging during the implementation of the CSP.
4. Assist the Programme area in the development of concept notes and project proposals.

KEY ACCOUNTABILITIES (not all-inclusive, within delegated authority):

### **5. Qualifications and Experience**

#### Education

Advanced university degree in one or more of the following disciplines: development studies, economics, environmental sciences, social studies or other related field.

#### Work experience

- Job related experience, with focus on project implementation.
- Postgraduate professional experience in a relevant field of work, with a background and great interest in international humanitarian development.
- Knowledge of project cycle approach.
- Previous experience with UN development or humanitarian work is an asset.

#### Languages

Fluency in oral and written English. Intermediate knowledge of Spanish

#### Other skills

Proficiency in Windows, MS Office (Word, Excel, PowerPoint, Outlook)

### Competencies

- Professionalism: Broad or specialized knowledge on Partnership and Reporting with understanding of the basic theoretical background.
- Teamwork: Ability to work collaboratively with colleagues to achieve organizational goals
- Communication: Ability to speak and write clearly and effectively. Good communication skills required to give and receive information and work with a variety of individuals.
- Planning and Organizing: Ability to develop clear goals that are consistent with agreed strategies.

### **6. Learning Elements**

At the end of the assignment the Fellow will be able to:

- Be familiar with food systems and climate change for accountability and learning in the largest humanitarian organization worldwide;
- Gather experience in Cuba WFP operation;
- On the job training on the preparation of proposals mainly in the areas of but not limited to: homegrown school feeding, resilience and climate adaptation, emergency responds, among other.ne
- Strengthen skills in qualitative and quantitative data analysis.
- Acquire experience in knowledge management, reporting and donor visibility measures.
- Develop and extensive knowledge of the Cuba context and food security situation at a time when the country is going through a historical process.

### **7. Content and methodology of the supervision**

The Fellow's work plan will encompass tasks across two key areas: Partnerships and Reporting. This plan will be discussed with the Head of Partnerships and implemented under the overall coordination of the Country Director. Accordingly, the fellow will report on the completion of assigned duties to their designated supervisor. On a monthly basis, the fellow will review and align priorities with the supervisor to ensure progress and responsiveness to evolving needs. The final performance evaluation will be prepared by the Partnerships Officer, in coordination with the Country Director.

### **8. Living conditions in the country**

Cuba is not subject to any UN Security Phase. Based on Security Incident Reports filed by UN personnel, the country ranks among the safest in the region, with UN staff rarely affected by criminal activity. However, the actual crime rate is difficult to assess due to the lack of publicly available official statistics. There have been no reported cases of kidnapping in Cuba. Incidents involving firearms are exceptionally rare, largely due to the government's strict regulation of firearm possession. Firearms are not readily accessible to the general population.

One notable risk for UN personnel involves traffic accidents, particularly during cross-country road missions. The most significant threat, however, stems from natural disasters—especially during the hurricane season. Tropical depressions, storms, and hurricanes have historically caused flooding, crop losses, and damage to critical infrastructure such as schools, hospitals, factories, warehouses, telecommunications, electricity networks, potable water system and roads. These events frequently—and at times severely—impact the country. Certain areas of the capital, including those housing UN offices, may experience flooding, potentially leading to temporary suspension of operations.

Cuba's national civil defense system is highly organized and has proven effective in saving lives through early warning mechanisms and well-tested evacuation protocols.

### Health Situation

Cuba boasts one of the highest doctor-to-patient ratios globally, and healthcare is free and widely accessible to Cuban nationals. However, the COVID-19 pandemic has strained public health services, which remain heavily focused on treating COVID-19 cases.

Foreign nationals are typically referred to designated clinics that charge in U.S. dollars and offer a limited range of services. Importantly, no emergency case is denied treatment at any hospital due to lack of funds.